I will survive

Running, hiding, and burrowing are good ways to avoid enemies. Over lots and lots of years, reptiles have developed many other fascinating methods of escape and self-defense.

A tail of escape

If caught by the tail, many lizards can get away by letting it break off. The bones in the tail have special cracks in them to allow this to happen. The tail will grow back during the next eight months.



Emerald tree skink

Lizards can use this tail trick more than once.

A sharper flavor

The armadillo lizard has a way of making its sharp, spiny body very difficult to attack and eat. Holding its tail in its mouth, it can curl its body into a prickly ball.





Horror show

Desert horned lizards use a strategy of surprise to defend themselves. They swell up in size and sometimes squirt blood from their eyes. Most attackers are so shocked they simply give up.



Kicking up a stink

To make up for its lack of size, the stinkpot turtle has to act very aggressively when caught. It also defends itself by squirting out a really smelly scent (musk) from "stink glands" in the skin of its legs.